

UPSC Philosophy Optional Paper 1 Simulation

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

SECTION A - Western Philosophy

Q1 (COMPULSORY)

(a) "Spinoza's God does no explanatory work outside the system." Examine this claim by comparing the role of God in Descartes and Spinoza. [10 marks]

Model answer (193 words; practice model, not official): For Descartes, God is a bridge. The cogito yields one certainty; divine veracity converts a rule read off that single case into a general licence to trust clear and distinct perception, and then licenses belief in an external world. Remove God and the system contracts to isolated intuitions. For Spinoza, God is not an added cause but the system itself. God, or Nature, is the one substance; Thought and Extension are its attributes; minds and bodies are its modes. Ethics I, P18 makes God the immanent, not the transitive, cause, so nothing is produced outside God and nothing needs to be certified from outside. The claim is therefore largely correct. Descartes' God performs an external epistemic function and can fail - exactly what Arnauld's Circle alleges. Spinoza's God performs no such function, because no gap between knower and known requires bridging: the order of ideas simply is the order of things (Ethics II, P7). One qualification is needed. Spinoza's God does other work: it grounds the necessity and intelligibility of everything that follows. Verdict. Descartes' God is a guarantor and can be attacked; Spinoza's God is a structure and can only be rejected wholesale.

(b) "The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions. [10 marks]

Model answer (175 words; practice model, not official): The problem. The sentence appears to be about something - a golden mountain - and nothing answers to that phrase. If the phrase were a name, the sentence would either be meaningless or would commit us to a non-existent object of the kind Meinong admitted; the golden mountain is his own stock example. The analysis. "The golden mountain" is an incomplete symbol: it has no meaning in isolation and disappears on analysis. The sentence asserts (Ex)[Gx & (Ay)(Gy → y = x) & Hx] - there is at least one golden mountain, at most one, and it is very high. The verdict. The existence conjunct is false, so the whole conjunction is false. The sentence is therefore neither meaningless nor about a subsisting entity, and asserting it commits us to nothing. Scope. "The golden mountain is not very high" is false on the primary occurrence, where the description takes wide scope, and true on the secondary occurrence, where the negation does - so the apparent conflict with excluded middle is an ambiguity of scope rather than a defect in logic. Point.

(c) Explain Heidegger's notion of das Man and show why 'falling' is not a moral failing. [10 marks]

Model answer (190 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Das Man names the impersonal "anyone" in whose name things are done, and falling is the ontological structure of absorption in that anonymity - which is why neither carries blame. The "they". Dasein exists with others - being-with (Mitsein, 26) is constitutive, not added on - and tends to lose itself in what "one" (man) does, says and thinks. Das Man is not "other people" but the anonymous norm-setter: one reads what one reads, one retires when one retires, and nobody in particular is answerable. Its three marks. Idle talk (Gerede) - passing along received opinions without genuine understanding; curiosity (Neugier) - flitting restlessly from novelty to novelty; ambiguity (Zweideutigkeit) - everything seems accessible and nothing is genuinely appropriated. Each is a deficient mode of an existentials rather than a vice. Why falling is not a failing. Falling (Verfallen) is Dasein's tendency to be absorbed in the world of its concern and in das Man. It is expressly not a theological "fall from grace" but an ontological structure: Dasein is inauthentic proximally and for the most part (zunächst und zumeist), and this is a structural feature of being-in-the-world, not a deficiency to be repented. Consequence.

(d) "The relation between cause and effect is one of constant conjunction". Examine Hume's criticism of causation in the light of the above statement. [10 marks]

Model answer (179 words; practice model, not official): The quoted sentence is accurate but incomplete, and examining it is the answer. Hume's analysis begins with what observation supplies: temporal priority, spatial contiguity and, across repeated instances, constant conjunction. What observation never supplies is a power or tie binding cause to effect. Applying the copy principle, Hume asks which impression the idea of necessary connexion is copied from. No external impression answers, and repetition adds nothing to the objects themselves. The internal route also fails: I have no impression of how the will moves a limb. What repetition does alter is the mind. After constant conjunction it is determined to pass from the idea of the cause to that of the effect, and this felt determination is an impression of reflection from which the idea of necessity is copied. Causal necessity is therefore projected onto objects, not read off them, and the mechanism is custom or habit. Verdict. Constant conjunction alone is mere regularity; Hume's account requires priority, contiguity and the felt determination. He does not deny causation - he relocates its necessity from the world to the observer.

(e) "The verification principle is a criterion of meaning and not of truth." Examine this claim. (Answer in about 150 words.) [10 marks]

Model answer (165 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The claim is correct, and the whole doctrine depends on it. The distinction. The principle asks not whether the world is as a sentence says, but whether there is any way the world could be that would make a difference to it. A sentence passes if it is analytic or if some possible experience bears on its truth. The decisive illustration. "The earth is flat" is demonstrably false and fully meaningful, because we know exactly what observations settle it. "The Absolute is beyond time" receives no truth-value at all, because no observation is even relevant to it. The first is refuted; the second is disqualified. Consequence. Because the verdict falls on the sentence rather than the object, the positivist may not add that the Absolute does not exist - a denial would need the very truth-conditions he says are missing. Verdict. Meaning, not truth: the criterion is a test of candidacy, and mistaking it for a test of truth destroys both halves of the doctrine.

Q2

(a) "The history of rationalist substance is a movement from dualism through monism to pluralism." Analyse the logic and the cost of this movement. [20 marks]

Model answer (354 words; practice model, not official): The sequence three, one, infinitely many captures a real dialectic, but its logic lies in changing criteria rather than in a preference for numbers. All three thinkers seek self-explanatory reality accessible to reason; they differ over what makes something ontologically basic. Descartes uses principal attributes and real distinction. God is infinite substance; mind and body are created substances whose essences are thought and extension. The gain is a clear basis both for a mathematical physics and for personal consciousness. The cost is a definitional equivocation, conceded in Principles I.51, and an interaction problem that his own criterion generates. Spinoza applies independence consistently. If substance is conceived through itself, dependent created substances cannot qualify; and substances sharing an attribute cannot be distinguished. God, or Nature, alone remains, while minds and bodies become modes under Thought and Extension. The gain is unity and the dissolution of interaction, since the order of ideas is the order of things. The cost is necessitarianism and the threat of acosmism. Leibniz accepts that extended composites are not ultimate but refuses to sacrifice individuals. Simplicity, perception and appetite define infinitely many monads; the identity of indiscernibles guarantees their uniqueness. The gain is active plurality and internal agency. The cost is that bodies become well-founded phenomena and that correspondence requires pre-established harmony and a divine selector. Movement | Problem solved | New problem generated | ---|---|---| Descartes -> Spinoza | dependence and interaction between created substances | finite individuality and contingency weaken | Spinoza -> Leibniz | restores genuine individual centres of activity | harmony and complete concepts strain explanation | The movement is therefore neither linear progress nor arbitrary disagreement. Each successor enforces one rationalist demand more strictly and pays elsewhere, because coherence, individuality and experiential plausibility cannot all be maximised at once. Verdict. Rationalist substance evolves through internal criticism, and the lesson is conceptual rather than historical: the definition of the basic unit already contains a theory of causation, of individuality and of freedom, so choosing a criterion of substance is choosing a metaphysics. That is also why the movement terminates only when Locke and Hume attack the innate resources which made the vocabulary of substance available in the first place.

(b) "All determination is negation." Comment with reference to Spinoza. [15 marks]

Model answer (266 words; practice model, not official): The formula is associated with Spinoza's Letter 50 to Jarig Jelles of 2 June 1674 - "determination is negation" - and was universalised into the Latin slogan by Hegel, which is how it entered the textbook tradition. It is not a sentence of the Ethics, and saying so is itself part of a correct comment. Its meaning is this. To determine a finite thing is to bound it as this rather than that; every limit excludes alternatives. Finitude therefore contains negation. In Spinoza's metaphysics three consequences follow. For God: substance is absolutely infinite and determined by nothing external, so God involves no negation whatever and is pure positive self-expression through infinite attributes. For finite modes: each is limited by other modes of the same nature - a body occupies this region and excludes others, a particular idea expresses only a bounded causal perspective - so their determination marks dependence and limitation. For knowledge and freedom: inadequate knowledge treats a finite thing in isolation, whereas adequate knowledge understands it through the affirmative whole of Nature, and the free person sees limitation and necessity under the aspect of eternity (sub specie aeternitatis) rather than imagining an independent will. Hegel's criticism is that Spinoza's infinite may swallow all finite determination, turning the world into negation - the acosmism charge. Spinoza can answer that what is negated is independent self-subsistence, not every form of reality: modes positively express divine power in determinate ways. Verdict. The dictum illuminates why finite beings are dependent, but it becomes reductive if limitation is mistaken for unreality. Spinoza needs both the negation of independence and the affirmation of modal expression.

(c) "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement. [15 marks]

Model answer (277 words; practice model, not official): Location and target. The sentence is from "The Refutation of Idealism" (Mind, 1903). Its target is the principle to be is to be perceived (esse est percipi), which requires that the object's being be nothing over and above its being perceived - and therefore that the sensation and its object be one thing. The argument the sentence states. Every sensation contains an act of awareness and an object of awareness. The quoted sentence identifies which is which: blue and green are the objects, and consciousness is what "both sensations have in common". If awareness were identical with its object, then the sensations of blue and of green would share nothing, since their objects differ, and would differ in nothing further, since there is nothing else in them. Both consequences are false, so awareness and object are distinct. The diagnosis. Consciousness is transparent or diaphanous: when we introspect the sensation of blue what we find is the blue, and the act is looked through rather than at. This explains why the conflation is so tempting; it is not itself a premiss of the refutation, and the argument above does not require isolating the act introspectively. The result, exactly bounded. Esse est percipi is not established, because the identity it requires has been denied on structural grounds. It does not follow that any object exists unperceived: distinguishing object from act shows only that the object is not constituted by the act. No theory of perception is offered - Moore leaves the relation between

sense-data and material objects unsettled. And Absolute Idealism is untouched, since it argues from internal relations and the incompleteness of finite determinations, not from the perceptual equation. Verdict.

Q3

(a) "The Tractatus is a book that succeeds by failing." Critically examine this claim with reference to the doctrine of saying and showing. [20 marks]

Model answer (400 words; practice model, not official): The claim, stated precisely. The Tractatus offers an account of the conditions under which a sentence has sense, derives from it a boundary around the sayable, and then discovers that its own sentences lie outside that boundary. The claim under examination is that this is the book's method rather than an accident: it succeeds as an elucidation precisely by failing as doctrine. The derivation that produces the failure. A proposition depicts only by sharing logical form with a possible situation. To depict that sharing, a further picture would have to stand outside logical form; but every picture already has logical form, and each attempted statement of form would need its own form stated. Hence "what can be shown, cannot be said" (4.1212). The result extends to the existence of objects, to the logical truths that show the scaffolding of the world (6.124), and to value, since "the sense of the world must lie outside the world" (6.41) and "there can be no propositions of ethics" (6.42). Why this convicts the book. Every sentence of the Tractatus is about logical form, objects, the general form of the proposition and the limits of language. None depicts a contingent state of affairs, so by its own criterion none says anything. Wittgenstein does not conceal this: 6.54 states that anyone who understands him recognises his propositions as nonsensical, having used them as steps to climb beyond them, and must then throw away the ladder. The two ways of reading the outcome. On the standard ineffability reading the failure is productive: something genuinely manifests itself - logical form, value, the mystical - which no proposition could carry. On the resolute or therapeutic reading of Diamond and Conant, no ineffable truths remain; the sentences are plain nonsense, and the therapy is the reader's coming to see that he was never given a doctrine. Assessment. The claim is largely correct, with one refinement. As a diagnosis the book succeeds: it unifies metaphysics, logic and value under one structural error - the attempt to state a condition of stating - and 6.53 converts that diagnosis into a method. As doctrine it fails, and the failure is self-inflicted rather than imposed by critics. What the slogan obscures is that "succeeding by failing" is intelligible on only one of the two readings: the standard reading can say what survives, whereas the resolute reading must say that nothing does.

(b) "Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is." In the light of this statement bring out the chief features of Sartre's conception of consciousness. [15 marks]

Model answer (270 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The formula is a definition, not a paradox: it says that consciousness is constituted by a distance from itself that it can never close. The contrast. Being-in-itself (en-soi) is full, solid, self-identical and opaque - "it is what it is" - and contingent, "de trop". Being-for-itself (pour-soi) is nihilating and self-surpassing, and never coincides with itself. "Is what it is not." Consciousness is always ahead of itself, projecting toward possibilities it does not yet possess; it is defined by a future that does not yet exist. "Is not what it is." Consciousness cannot coincide with its past or its facticity. Sartre's waiter is a waiter in his facticity and is not one in his transcendence: he can question the role, resent it, leave it. How this is possible. Nihilation (neantisation): consciousness stands back from what is and negates it - questioning, imagining alternatives, projecting beyond it. The for-itself is "the being by which nothingness (neant) comes into the world." What it generates. Freedom, since nothing in me is fixed enough to determine me; bad faith, the attempt to be self-identical anyway by collapsing into facticity or transcendence alone; ecstatic temporality, since the for-itself exists as past-facticity and future-project; being-for-others, since the Look confers an outside I cannot occupy; and the impossible desire to be a pour-soi-en-soi, which is God - hence "man is a useless passion". Objection. Is non-self-identity coherent, or a contradiction in phenomenological dress? The reply is that the for-itself has no completed nature with which to be identical, since it exists as a relation to its own possibilities rather than as a thing with properties; whether that succeeds is contested.

(c) Examine Hume's refutation of Causal relation and Kant's response to it. [15 marks]

Model answer (285 words; practice model, not official): Hume. Observation of causal sequences delivers only temporal priority, spatial contiguity and constant conjunction; no impression of a power or tie is given, and repetition adds nothing to the objects. The internal route through volition fails equally. What repetition alters is the mind, which after constant conjunction is determined to pass from cause to effect - an impression of reflection from which the idea of necessity is copied. Hence two definitions of cause: regular succession of similars, and an object whose appearance conveys the thought to the other. The consequence is that inductive inference rests on custom, not reason. Kant. He does not dispute the negative finding; he agrees that necessary connexion is not copied from a sensory impression. His answer is transcendental. In the Second Analogy the category of cause is an a priori rule required to distinguish an objective succession of events from the merely subjective succession of my perceptions. "Every event has a cause" is therefore synthetic a priori for possible experience: the understanding supplies necessary temporal ordering to phenomena, and objective empirical causation is rescued without any claim about causality among things in themselves. Examination. The Humean challenge is that Kant has built the category into the definition of objective experience rather than proving it. Kant's reply is that without rule-governed synthesis, experience of an event would not be possible, so the presupposition is a condition of the fact to be explained. Verdict. Kant is correctly aimed: Hume's conclusion follows from the atomism of impressions, and it is that atomism, not the inference, which Kant attacks. Whether a condition of possible experience amounts to knowledge of nature remains contested - which is why analysis should close by grading, not by declaring a winner.

Q4

(a) "Anxiety is not a stronger kind of fear." Examine the role of anxiety in Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre, and assess whether a mood can disclose a philosophical truth. [20 marks]

Model answer (395 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. Fear and anxiety differ in kind, not degree, and the shared argument in all three thinkers turns on that difference - though the conclusion each draws is different. The general argument. (i) Moods are not private colourings added to a neutral world; they are ways in which one's situation is disclosed. (ii) Fear discloses an entity as threatening and keeps us within the world of concern. (iii) Anxiety has no entity as its object and therefore cannot disclose an entity. (iv) Yet it plainly discloses something, since it has definite content and is not mere confusion. (v) Therefore what it discloses is a structure. (vi) Therefore anxiety is philosophically privileged: the one mood in which existence as a whole becomes an issue. Kierkegaard. The Concept of Anxiety (1844), by Vigilius Haufniensis: "the object of anxiety is a nothing"; what appears is possibility, "the possibility of being able". Anxiety is "the dizziness of freedom", present already in innocence, and the presupposition of the leap. Heidegger. Being and Time 40: in anxiety "the world has the character of complete insignificance" - the totality of involvements collapses and Dasein is thrown back on its bare that-it-is. That in the face of which and that for which one is anxious are the same: being-in-the-world. Anxiety discloses Dasein as solus ipse and frees it for authentic choosing. In "What is Metaphysics?" (1929) he adds that it reveals the Nothing (das Nichts) - "nothing noths", never "noughts". Sartre. Being and Nothingness (1943), Part I. On the cliff path I feel fear of the drop, then realise that nothing prevents me from throwing myself over - vertigo before my own freedom. The gambler finds yesterday's firm resolution present but powerless: it must be remade now, and nothing guarantees he will remake it. Anguish is distinct from nausea, which discloses the contingency of the in-itself. Assessment. The naturalist replies that anxiety is a clinical or neurochemical state with no cognitive credentials. The counter is that the existentialist claim is not that anxious people know more, but that the structure of the mood - having no object - is itself the datum requiring explanation, and no reduction of it to an unnoticed object has succeeded. Verdict: a mood can disclose a structure without becoming infallible cognition; naturalistic and clinical explanations remain compatible competitors rather than refuted rivals, and the three analyses must not be merged into one mood theory.

(b) Examine the protocol-sentence debate and assess its significance for the verification theory of meaning. (Answer in about 250 words.) [15 marks]

Model answer (274 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The protocol-sentence debate is the most damaging objection to logical positivism precisely because it was raised inside the Vienna Circle: the school that made verification the criterion of meaning could not agree on what verification terminates in. The question. What is the form and status of protocol sentences (Protokollsätze) - incorrigible foundations, or ordinary revisable sentences? Schlick. In "Über das Fundament der Erkenntnis" (1934) the base consists of affirmations (Konstatierungen) such as "here now blue", absolutely certain because understanding the sentence and verifying it are one and the same act. Schlick's own catch is fatal: an affirmation cannot be written down and preserved, since recording it yields a hypothesis about a past moment. Its certainty is momentary and unusable. Neurath. In "Protokollsätze" (1932) protocols are physicalist, observer- and time-indexed, and fallible like any other sentence; "statements are compared with statements, not with 'experiences'". His image is of sailors rebuilding their ship on the open sea. Carnap. In "Über Protokollsätze" (1932) the form of a protocol is not a fact to be discovered but a matter of choice of language - tolerance applied to the Circle's own foundations, which effectively ends foundationalism inside the Circle. Significance. The criterion presupposes that observation-statements are epistemically privileged. Schlick's base is certain but unrecordable, Neurath's is recordable but revisable, and Carnap's is conventional; a chosen base cannot ground a criterion advertised as a discovery about meaning. Verdict. Schlick's objection that coherence alone admits a consistent fairy-tale is not fully met by Neurath's appeal to encyclopaedic scientific practice, which makes the selection sociological; and the debate moved positivism toward intersubjective, system-level testing without thereby making Quine's later holism a positivist conclusion.

(c) "We can affirm the truth of any sentence in our total system, in the face of whatever experience, just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere." Discuss this statement in the light of Quine's 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism'. [15 marks]

Model answer (297 words; practice model, not official): Thesis. The sentence is a claim about where blame for a failed prediction may be assigned, not a licence to believe anything: the clause "just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere" names the price, and the price is the doctrine. Where it sits. It belongs to 6 of "Two Dogmas of Empiricism" (1951), after both dogmas have been removed. Statements "face the tribunal of sense experience not individually but only as a corporate body", so the unit of empirical significance is the whole of science. The mechanism. A hypothesis entails an observation only with auxiliaries: the testable claim is $(H \ \& \ A) \rightarrow O$. When experience yields not-O, modus tollens delivers only not-(H & A) - H is false or some element of A is false - and logic never names the guilty conjunct. Three responses are therefore available: revise a peripheral belief, revise a deep interior statement, or plead hallucination and revise the observation itself. The third is what makes the quoted sentence literally true. The historical illustration. Anomalies in Uranus's orbit were met by revising the auxiliary assumption about the number of planets, and Neptune was found (1846). The identical strategy applied to Mercury produced the hypothesised planet "Vulcan", which does not exist; there the correct revision was the deep one - general relativity (1915). Same logical situation, opposite correct responses, no advance rule. What blocks relativism. Revision is chosen on grounds of simplicity, conservatism and fecundity, and in Philosophy of Logic (1970) Quine adds the maxim of minimum mutilation and warns that "change of logic" is change of subject. No statement is revisable by nature; only by choice, and choice has costs. Verdict. The statement is right about confirmation and easily misread as relativism; truncating it at "come what may" is what produces the misreading.

SECTION B - Indian Philosophy

Q5 (COMPULSORY)

(a) "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhāṅginaya) in the light of above statement. [10 marks]

Model answer (154 words; practice model, not official): Jainism agrees with half of the statement and rejects the other half. It agrees that human knowledge is limited: ordinary cognition is *ksayopasamika*, partial because knowledge-obscurer karma is only partly removed, and ordinary perception is only conventionally direct. It refuses the inference to relativism. The sevenfold judgement - the seven forms generated by affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under the operator *syat* - records the respects in which a predication holds, using the indices of substance, place, time and mode. Each form is a definite assertion, not a probability estimate; *syat* does not mean "perhaps". Critically, the difference from empiricist relativism is ontological. For the empiricist, relativity attaches to knowledge because there is no access beyond experience. For Jainism, relativity attaches to finite judgement while the aspects remain objectively in the object, and omniscience remains internally possible. Hence the statement describes a Jaina premise, not a Jaina conclusion: partiality of knowing does not entail relativity of truth.

(b) Discuss the nature and different stages of Samadhi as per Patanjala yoga and examine the role of Isvara in it. [10 marks]

Model answer (191 words; practice model, not official): Absorption (samadhi) in Patanjala Yoga is the highest refinement of attention, not passivity, and it is the threshold of liberating discernment. Object-supported absorption (*samprajnata*) retains a support and is with-seed (*sabija*); Yoga-sutra 1.17 characterises it by deliberation, reflection, joy and bare I-am-ness, while Yoga-sutra 1.42-1.44 separately classifies coalescence (*samapatti*) as *savitarka* and *nirvitarka* for gross objects and *savicara* and *nirvicara* for subtle ones. The clarity of subtle coalescence yields truth-bearing insight (*rtambhara prajna*). Supra-cognitive absorption (*asamprajnata*) has impression-residue; when even that is restrained, absorption is seedless (*nirbija*); cloud-of-dharma absorption (*dharmamegha-samadhi*) is the culmination. The Lord (Isvara) is a special conscious witness (*purusa-visesa*) untouched by affliction, action, fruition and deposit, denoted by the sacred syllable (*pranava*). Dedication to him (*Isvara-pranidhana*) is a positive observance, a component of preparatory discipline and an independent means to absorption; it stabilises the mind-field and removes the nine obstacles (*antaraya*). Examined strictly, however, his role is instrumental and not constitutive. He is neither material cause nor the Nyaya creator, and he does not bestow isolation; liberation still follows the practitioner's own discriminative discernment. Yoga's theism is therefore real but bounded - practice-enabling rather than creation-first.

(c) Do you think Carvaka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer. [10 marks]

Model answer (190 words; practice model, not official): Yes in spirit, no in method. The case for. The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Carvaka theory "may also be called positivism, because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena", and compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Carvaka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, action and moral consequence (*karma*) and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and heaven are said to become "meaningless". The case against. Positivism is built on inference - science is systematised inference - which Carvaka denies means of valid knowledge (*pramana*)-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Carvaka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Carvaka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart. Verdict: an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. Radical empiricism or naturalistic materialism is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Carvaka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route.

(d) Critically discuss the metaphysical status of a Jiva and a Purusa according to Samkhya philosophy. [10 marks]

Model answer (187 words; practice model, not official): For Samkhya the conscious witness (*purusa*) is the metaphysical reality: pure, self-luminous, inactive and changeless consciousness, wholly beyond the three qualities. The empirical self (*jiva*) is not a further principle in the enumeration of twenty-five; it is the witness as empirically conditioned through identification with intellect, I-maker, mind, body and the karmic stream. The mechanism is reflection. The determinative intellect, being predominantly luminous and therefore transparent, receives the reflection of the witness; the resulting cognition generates false appropriation (*abhimana*) - "I am the doer, knower, enjoyer". The insentient organ thus appears conscious while the inactive witness appears to be an agent. The empirical self is precisely that two-way appearance stabilised into an apparent person. Two consequences follow. Bondage is misidentification rather than a real modification of the witness, and liberation is the correction of attribution rather than the destruction of an entity. Critically, the account is elegant but exposed: if the witness is never really conditioned, it becomes unclear in what sense there was ever a problem for it, and Samkhya's reply - that the problem was always one of attribution - clarifies the question rather than demonstrating an answer.

(e) Explain the ground on which Carvaka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge. [10 marks]

Model answer (193 words; practice model, not official): The ground is the impossibility of establishing invariable concomitance (*vyapti*). Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived *sadhya*, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance - "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a means of valid knowledge (*pramana*), that universal must be beyond doubt. It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived. Nor by inference: that would be a *petitio principii*, since the further inference needs its own invariable concomitance (*vyapti*). Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself." Hidden limiting condition (*upadhi*) completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden

conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified. Hence truth is "only an accident, and a separable one" in inference - not the guaranteed character a means of valid knowledge (pramana) requires.

Q6

(a) "Jainism preserves the reality of the world at the cost of the simplicity of logic; Advaita preserves the simplicity of logic at the cost of the reality of the world." Critically examine this comparison. [20 marks]

Model answer (369 words; practice model, not official): The comparison is illuminating but requires correction on both sides. On the Jaina side it is broadly accurate. Jainism refuses to treat either permanence or change as appearance. The real is defined as originating, decaying and persisting together, so both are secured - but the price is that predication must be indexed. Assertion carries the operator syat; opposed predications are separated by substance, place, time and mode; and the exhaustive schema of qualified assertion contains seven forms rather than a simple affirmation and denial. Ontological economy is sacrificed too: six substances, innumerable souls and material action-matter are admitted because each performs explanatory work. The world is saved, and logic becomes intricate. On the Advaita side the statement needs care. Advaita does not abandon the world; it grades it. The world is empirically real and only ultimately mithya, and sublation, not denial, is the operative notion. What Advaita gains is a single ultimate reality with a straightforward account of contradiction: opposed characterisations belong to different levels, and the lower is finally cancelled. So the accurate formulation is that Advaita preserves logical simplicity by admitting levels of reality, whereas Jainism preserves ontological plurality by admitting respects of predication. That reformulation locates the real difference. Both schools face the problem of apparently opposed predicates. Advaita separates them vertically, by rank, with the lower cancelled at realisation. Jainism separates them horizontally, by aspect, with nothing cancelled at all. Vertical separation buys a simple logic and requires a doctrine of appearance; horizontal separation buys an unqualified realism and requires a doctrine of conditional assertion. Critically, each pays where the other saves. Samkara charges that Jaina qualification erodes assertoric force and that a doctrine which qualifies even itself cannot claim universal scope. The Jaina replies that reflexive qualification is obedience rather than exemption, and counter-charges that treating the world as ultimately mithya purchases simplicity by demoting the very reality it set out to explain. Neither charge is answerable from a neutral standpoint, because each presupposes what the other denies. The defensible verdict is that the quoted comparison identifies a genuine trade-off but mislabels the Advaita side. Jainism trades logical simplicity for unqualified realism; Advaita trades ontological plurality, not the world itself, for a single unsublated real.

(b) Compare and contrast the views of Sankara and Ramanuja regarding the status of the world. [15 marks]

Model answer (265 words; practice model, not official): Both thinkers agree on three things: the world depends entirely on ultimate reality; there is no second independent principle; and scripture is the final authority for what the world is. They diverge on what dependence permits. For Sankara the world is an apparent transformation (vivarta). Ultimate reality does not really change; the world is a sublatale appearance on a real substrate, as the snake is on the rope. It is therefore dependently real (mithya) - denied absolute reality but retaining public, law-governed empirical validity - and emphatically not wholly non-existent (tuccha). The three levels of reality make this intelligible: the absolute alone is ultimate, the world and the Lord are empirical, dream and shell-silver are apparent. For Ramanuja the world is real. It is the non-conscious (acit) dimension of ultimate reality's body, related by inseparable dependence (aprthaksiddhi). Creation is a real manifestation in which the subtle cause-state of the non-conscious mode becomes the gross effect-state, while God's essential auspicious nature is unaltered. Because effects are real, the world is a meaningful field of duty, devotion and divine manifestation. The contrast can be tabulated: reality of the world - dependent appearance against real manifestation; change in the absolute - denied against accepted in a qualified sense through modes; soteriology - the world subluted in knowledge against the world meaningful in devotion; the God-world relation - empirical against an intrinsic body-soul relation. The evaluative line is that each protects what the other qualifies: Sankara protects absoluteness by reducing world-status, Ramanuja protects world-status by qualifying absoluteness. Vallabha's unchanged real manifestation shows the fork is not exhaustive, but the two positions remain the decisive alternatives.

(c) "So long as there are changes and modifications in citta, the self is reflected therein, and, in the absence of discriminative knowledge, identifies itself with them." Present an appraisal of Yoga Soteriology in the light of the above statement. [15 marks]

Model answer (286 words; practice model, not official): The quoted statement compresses Yoga's entire diagnosis. The mind-field really changes, since Yoga inherits real transformation (parinamavada) and recognises transformations of restraint, absorption and one-pointedness in a persisting substrate. Because the mind-field is lucid-predominant and transparent, the witness's light is reflected in it (pratibimba); and because the relation is mere proximity (sannidhi-matra), the whole transformation occurs on the mind's side while the witness remains unchanged (aparinamin). Where discriminative discernment (viveka-khyati) is absent, the borrowed light is read as the mind's own and the witness's witnesshood is read as agency - the conflation named egoity (asmita). Appraised positively, the soteriology is strong. It supplies a rigorous phenomenology of mental process - modification, memory, sleep, impression, affliction, absorption. It integrates psychology, ethics and metaphysics, since restraints, moral causation and mental restraint form one system. It offers an operational path rather than speculation: practice and dispassion, preparatory discipline, the eight limbs and graded absorption. And the isolation chapter's realist arguments against consciousness-only idealism show genuine metaphysical commitment. The weaknesses are equally locatable. Mere proximity names the relation between an inactive witness and an active nature more clearly than it explains it, and Advaita and Nyaya press exactly there. The Lord's explanatory role is limited: he aids practice but is neither creator nor material cause nor the giver of isolation. And the value of contentless pure consciousness can be questioned by schools that define fulfilment through knowledge, relation, bliss or activity. Two matters remain genuinely contested: the commentarial status of joy and I-am-ness within the absorption taxonomy, and whether isolation is austere aloneness or blissful self-abidance. The balanced verdict is that Yoga's account of how bondage operates is more

secure than its account of how the two principles are related at all.

Q7

(a) Explain with reference to Yoga Philosophy, the nature of klesas. How does the removal of these lead to kaivalya? [20 marks]

Model answer (358 words; practice model, not official): The afflictions (klesa) are not surface thoughts but the causal colourings of mental life that generate binding action and sustain the cycle of rebirth. Yoga lists five: ignorance (avidya), egoity (asmita), attachment (raga), aversion (dvesa) and clinging to life (abhinivesa). Ignorance is the root and the field in which the rest grow; it is defined as taking the non-eternal for the eternal, the impure for the pure, the painful for the pleasant and the non-self for the self. Egoity is the identification of the seer with the instrument of seeing. Attachment and aversion follow remembered pleasure and remembered pain. Clinging to life is instinctive and, significantly, present even in the learned - which shows that afflictions are carried by impressions rather than by opinions. Afflictions operate at four intensities: dormant (prasupta), attenuated (tanu), interrupted (vicchinna) and fully active (udara). Dormancy is not destruction, and interruption is merely the temporary dominance of an opposing tendency, so the absence of felt affliction is weak evidence of progress. Their removal leads to isolation through a stated causal chain. Afflictions motivate action; action deposits a karmic store (karmasaya) rooted in the afflictions; the store ripens as a threefold fruition (vipaka) of birth (jati), life-span (ayus) and experience (bhoga); and that experience generates fresh reaction, closing the loop in renewed birth. Because the first link is psychological, the engine can be jammed at its source. Yoga's therapy is graded accordingly. Preparatory discipline (kriya-yoga) - austerity (tapas), self-study (svadhyaya) and dedication to the Lord (Isvara-pranidhana) - is prescribed expressly to attenuate the afflictions and prepare absorption. The eight-limbed discipline purifies conduct, embodiment and attention. Meditation burns the subtle forms of affliction that ethical restraint alone cannot reach. As the mind-field is purified, absorption stabilises and discriminative discernment (viveka-khyati) matures. With higher dispassion (para-vairagya) the practitioner ceases to crave even powers and exalted states, and cloud-of-dharma absorption (dharma-megha-samadhi) rains down the fullness of discernment. Afflictions and binding action cease; the constituent qualities undergo involution (pratiprasava) for that witness; and consciousness abides in its own nature (svarupa-pratistha). This is isolation (kaivalya) - not union, not annihilation, but the ending of a misidentification whose machinery has been dismantled at the root.

(b) Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Carvaka and Jainism. [15 marks]

Model answer (275 words; practice model, not official): Epistemic root. Carvaka admits one means of valid knowledge (pramana), perception (pratyaksa). Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge - mati, sruta, avadhi, manahpariyaya, kevala - and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this. Definition of the real. For Jainism, sat is utpada-vyaya-dhauvya - origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as dravya while its pariyayas change. Carvaka has no such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all. Constituents. Four bhutas for Carvaka; six dravyas for Jainism - individual self (jiva), pudgala, dharma, adharma, akasa, kala. Akasa is rejected by the Carvaka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation. Soul and consciousness. Carvaka: no individual self (jiva); the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many individual self (jivas), with consciousness their inseparable essence - expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Carvaka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions". Standpoint. Jainism's anekantavada, with nayavada and syadvada, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Carvaka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all. Action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation. Jainism: action and moral consequence (karma) as subtle matter adhering to the individual self (jiva), bhavabandha and dravyabandha, with liberation (moksa) through the three jewels and kevala-jnana. Carvaka: no action and moral consequence (karma), and maranam eva apavargah. Verdict. Their agreement is instructive: both are Veda-rejecting school (nastika), both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances - which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Carvaka can only assert them side by side.

(c) How do the Advaita Vedantins react to the Prakrtiparinamavada of the Samkhya philosophy? How do the Samkhyas defend their own position in this regard? Discuss. [15 marks]

Model answer (286 words; practice model, not official): Samkhya's doctrine of the real transformation of primordial nature holds that the effect pre-exists in its material cause and is genuinely manifested through the modification of the three qualities: in equilibrium each quality transforms homogeneously, and on disturbance the qualities transform heterogeneously to yield the manifest principles. Advaita reacts on three fronts. First, an unconscious first principle cannot be the cause described in the Upanisads, where the source is spoken of as conscious and knowing. Second, an ultimate that really transforms becomes mutable, and a mutable principle is dependent rather than ultimate; the world's dependence is therefore better explained by superimposition. Third, Advaita substitutes apparent transformation (vivarta) for real transformation, so that Brahman is the cause without undergoing change, as a rope is the "cause" of the snake seen in it. Samkhya defends itself equally on three fronts. First, the selectivity of production is real: curd comes from milk and not from water, and only a real material continuity explains that restriction, whereas an appearance-theory leaves selectivity unexplained. Second, mutability does not disqualify nature from being ultimate, because nature is by definition the principle whose being is modification; the objection would tell only against a changeless ultimate. Third, treating the world as appearance purchases the immutability of the cause at the cost of the reality of bondage and release, which Samkhya's realism refuses to surrender. Both schools deny production from sheer non-being, so the dispute is not about the pre-existent effect but about the reality of the transformation. The exchange therefore terminates in a clash of first principles: Samkhya preserves the reality of the world and pays with a mutable ultimate, while Advaita preserves an immutable ultimate and pays with the ultimate unreality of the world.

(a) Analyse the Jaina fourteen stages of spiritual development. How do the two ladders explain spiritual relapse, and what does this show about the relation between insight and conduct in Jainism? [20 marks]

Model answer (384 words; practice model, not official): The fourteen stages (gunasthana) map the soul's movement from false vision to final liberation, and they are graded by karmic condition rather than by external observance. Stages one to three describe wrong, falling and mixed orientation. Stage four, right vision without restraint, is the decisive breakthrough: right vision (samyag-darsana) becomes stable enough to orient the path even though conduct has not yet followed. Stage five introduces partial restraint through lay vows. Stages six and seven mark full restraint with and then without negligence. Stages eight to ten describe progressive purification of the passions, from unprecedented purification through advanced purification to the condition in which only subtle greed remains. Stages eleven and twelve mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion. Stage thirteen is the embodied omniscient being, and stage fourteen the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state. The two ladders explain relapse without treating it as mere failure. On the ladder of suppression (upasama-sreni), delusion is covered rather than removed; such a soul may reach the eleventh stage, but because suppressed delusion retains its potency the fall is necessary, not accidental. On the ladder of annihilation (ksapaka-sreni), delusion is destroyed, so the twelfth stage is stable and the ascent continues to omniscience. Three philosophical consequences follow. First, appearance and condition come apart: two souls may look identical at the tenth stage and have opposite futures, which is why Jainism refuses to identify spiritual attainment with observable conduct alone. Second, insight and conduct are interdependent rather than alternative. Right vision at stage four is genuine yet insufficient; conduct without right vision has no orientation; and the ladder records the joint operation of the three jewels. Third, omniscience is decoupled from disembodiment: destroying the destructive karmas yields omniscience at stage thirteen, while the non-destructive karmas sustain body, status, lifespan and felt experience until the end. Critically, an Advaita-style objection holds that a fourteen-stage ladder mechanises liberation, substituting a karmic audit for insight. The Jaina reply is that insight which does not destroy karma has not yet done its work, and that the ladder simply records the difference between a covered and a destroyed defilement. The scheme is therefore best evaluated as a psychology of purification with an unusually honest account of relapse, and its taxonomic weight is the price of that honesty.

(b) 'Both Ascetic and materialist are partial in their negation of each other'. Explain Sri Aurobindo's integral philosophy in the light of the above statement. [15 marks]

Model answer (294 words; practice model, not official): The printed statement criticises the ascetic and the materialist for what they deny, not for what they affirm. The ascetic affirms Spirit and denies Matter; the materialist affirms Matter and denies Spirit. Each position is credible on its own evidence and incredible on the other's, and both are partial because each absolutises one pole of reality and rejects the other. Aurobindo's integral philosophy keeps both affirmations and drops both denials: Spirit is the truth of Matter, and Matter is the field of Spirit's manifestation. Each half is licensed by a doctrine rather than asserted. Involution licenses the first: the Divine conceals itself through graded planes until, in Matter and the Inconscient, consciousness is wholly hidden but not abolished, so matter is Spirit in self-oblivion rather than an anti-spiritual substance. Evolution licenses the second: what was involved re-emerges, Matter yielding Life and Life yielding Mind, so earthly existence is the very field in which the Divine becomes manifest. The metaphysical condition of both is a dynamic Absolute. Existence-Consciousness-Bliss is not static being but consciousness-force, which is why manifestation neither requires an illusion nor diminishes the Divine; and the Supermind supplies the mediating truth-principle that lets the One become Many without fragmentation. The consequences are practical. Against the ascetic, liberation is a beginning rather than a terminus, and Integral Yoga seeks the transformation of mind, life and body rather than release from them. Against the materialist, consciousness is not a late by-product but the involved reality that evolution is recovering. The aim is therefore neither world-flight nor flat naturalism but divine life on earth, realised individually in the gnostic being. The synthesis is only as secure as the involution premise on which it rests, but it does succeed in diagnosing both partialities from a single principle.

(c) Explain the concepts of 'Anyathasiddha' and 'Ananyathasiddha' in the context of Asatkaryavada. [15 marks]

Model answer (273 words; practice model, not official): Non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkaryavada) holds that the effect does not lie latent in its cause but is a genuinely new production. This creates an immediate difficulty. Since the effect is not located in the cause, causal necessity must be located instead in the antecedent relation - and a bare antecedent relation over-generates, because innumerable things precede any effect. Nyaya's definition therefore builds in a filter. A cause is an unconditional and invariable antecedent: prior (purvavrtti), invariably prior (niyata-purvavrtti) and not otherwise established (ananyathasiddha). The complete cause is the causal complex (karana-samagri), including the absence of a blocking condition (pratibandhakabhava). Ananyathasiddha marks indispensable causal relevance: the item's connection to the effect is not accounted for by anything else. Anyathasiddha marks an antecedent that is otherwise established and is therefore excluded, however reliably it precedes. Five classical exclusions, each a different kind of irrelevance: the colour of the potter's staff is a quality of an instrument, not a producer; the potter's father is a remote cause of the potter, not of the pot; the sound of the staff is a co-effect of the same operation; all-pervading space is an ever-present background, not a distinctive antecedent; the potter's donkey is an accidental companion. The pair is thus not a refinement but a load-bearing device: without it, an antecedent-based definition of cause could not survive, and the doctrine of new production would collapse into the claim that everything preceding a pot causes it. Samkhya presses the residual question of restriction - why only these causes yield this effect. Nyaya answers by invariability rather than by latency, which is coherent but leaves the restriction unexplained at a deeper level.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS